



Temple Run on Android

The perfect fun to enjoy with your friends. The mega-addictive entertainment Temple Run is now on Android. <http://dgit.in/MfiEMh>

Web Developer

This extension-cum-toolbar for Chrome adds various tools useful for web development. <http://dgit.in/NIUk5y>

Linux Distro Comparison

Last Tux Standing

We pick six popular Linux distros to tell you how they compare against each other

Vaibhav Kaushal

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

There was a time when almost no one wanted to talk about why Linux is good. Then came Ubuntu and Android (with a Linux kernel), which brought Linux back in the game. Android changed the mobile and tablet arena and Ubuntu attracted a lot of desktop users. While Windows is still the mightiest of all desktop OSes, Linux is steadily growing in all aspects – number of users, user-friendliness, new tools from a large community of developers, easier administration and accessibility. Linux isn't 'only for geeks' anymore. Let us see why.

OPENSUSE 12.1

OpenSUSE is Novell's community project, the same as Fedora is a community project funded by RedHat. However, SLED (SUSE Linux Enterprise Desktop) is a Novell offering for Enterprise Desktop users and is one of the best in that arena. The advanced features built into OpenSUSE can be thus credited to SLED. OpenSUSE prefers KDE for its default desktop environment and thus comes with all the advanced features and customisation options offered by KDE. Its control centre and installer are both called YaST (Yet another Setup Tool). YaST is the most advanced GUI control centre you can get on Linux by

any means. Since YaST is a plugable system, when you install extra software such as Apache Web server, Samba server and FTP server, you would also get the GUI configuration tools right in the YaST control centre. It's a great option if you want to control fine bits and pieces of OpenSUSE's installation using GUI (advanced users can, at any time, go for the command line).

The detailed and advanced features of its installer are also credited to YaST. In practice, YaST installer is the most

advanced installer you can get for any OS – nothing offers so much control over the install procedure, with detailed help and descriptions of everything you want to do during installation – right from individual package selection, bootloader install, locale and default run-level settings to firewall configuration and beyond. All of this is certainly a pain for someone who has never tried Linux before; but OpenSUSE makes sure that if you do not understand all the details it

intimidates you with, the GUI sequential install procedure would not harm your current installation. The simple mantra here is – "If you do not understand something, read help; if you still do not understand it well enough, do not touch it".

OpenSUSE is released every 8-10 months and there are periodic updates in between. If you want to stay on the bleeding edge of latest software, go for the Tumbleweed repository. The one great thing about

